between identity and authorization, making sure that both the inputs for access decisions and the logic that evaluates them adhere to the same standards of review and accountability.

Governance also became the language of compliance. By connecting policies and ADRs to regulatory controls, ACME replaced manual evidence gathering with ongoing verification. Decision logs, version control history, and audit records served as live proof of compliance, turning external oversight into confirmation of internal discipline. Over time, governance shifted from a defensive posture—proving compliance after the fact—to an operational capability that continually generates assurance as a natural part of daily work.

Together, these practices turned governance into ACME's quiet foundation for trust. They unified how the company expressed intent, measured assurance, and responded to change. Governance ensured that access decisions were not only technically sound but also socially legitimate, reflecting clear choices made openly, recorded for accountability, and reinforced through collaboration between people and systems.

In the next chapter, we'll build on this foundation to examine how governance supports the broader goals of information security, demonstrating how well-managed authorization becomes the core principle for protecting systems, data, and the people who rely on them.

14.8 Summary

- Policy governance turns authorization from a technical activity into a core organizational discipline that connects business goals to how systems behave.
- Governance creates a framework for accountability—outlining who owns, reviews, and approves each policy during its lifecycle.
- The policy management lifecycle guarantees that policies are created, reviewed, deployed, monitored, updated, and retired in a controlled, auditable manner.
- Clearly defined roles like policy owner, author, reviewer, approver, coordinator, and auditor prevent confusion and ensure accountability